

English-I Lab (SL1016)

Lab Final Exam

Date: December 16, 2025.

Course Instructor(s)

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Total Time: 3 hrs

Total Marks: 80

Total Questions: 6

Roll No. 25L-5575

Section BSC663 LC

Student Signature Shubh Chaudhary

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Instructions: Attempt all the questions in sequence. No cutting/overwriting is allowed.

CL0 4: Develop well-structured informational and expository essays demonstrating clarity and organization in peer/group tasks.

Question 1: Read the given excerpts and write a Cause & Effect essay on the topic "Causes/ Effects of Skipping Breakfast among Teenagers" by following the given guidelines. /25

Your Essay must include:

- Introductory Paragraph
 - o Reader's Hook
 - o Lead-in Statement
 - o Three-point thesis statement (underline three points)
 - o Transitional hooks
- Body Paragraphs
 - o Topic sentence
 - o 2 Major & Minor details
 - o Transitional hooks
- Conclusion

skipping breakfast
Teenagers who often struggle with poor cognitive performance, leading to mental health issues.
- skipping breakfast -> anxiety, work
- mental health -> depressive
- poor cognitive performance -> Higher Impulsivity
in attention is memory
- Higher levels

(Note: Keep the word count within the range of 320-350 words. Use the given excerpts as a source of information; however, you may add more information where required, and do not copy-paste the same information.)

Breakfast constitutes one of the most important meals of the day. After an overnight fast, blood glucose concentration tends to be at its lowest upon waking, which could negatively affect daytime cognitive functions if not restored. Cascades of biochemical reactions involving not only depleted blood glucose and impaired glucose homeostasis but also their related physiological mechanisms (e.g., insulin, cortisol, serotonin, and glutamate) can result due to breakfast skipping. Irregular breakfast consumption has been shown to be linked to elevated risks of cardiovascular diseases, as well as mental health problems, particularly depressive symptoms, in a range of studies. Yet, skipping breakfast has become increasingly common in today's society, particularly among young people.

While youth signifies a time of increased opportunities for social network building and the crystallisation of self-concepts, the marked neurobiological, social, physical, and psychological changes that take place during this life stage also make young people more vulnerable to the onset of mental disorders. Despite the significant burden of disease associated with depression and anxiety in youth, mental health help-seeking remains a persistent challenge. In our previous youth epidemiological study in Hong Kong, we found that only 16.7% of those with a 12-month major depressive episode were utilising any psychiatric or psychological services, with financial costs and accessibility difficulties reported as two leading causes of non-utilisation. Similar observations of non-help-seeking among youths have been reported in other countries. In addition to enhancing youth-friendly and evidence-based services in the community, determining the possible benefits of building healthy habits, such as regular breakfast consumption, in mental health may offer more practical and low-stigma strategies for well-being in the population.

Among existing studies that have explored the effects of breakfast skipping on young people, the majority focused on cognitive performance deficits in school-aged children. A related systematic review found that children and adolescents who do not consume breakfast tend to show poorer cognitive performance of the brain, particularly in tasks involving attention, memory, and executive functions. The researchers, nevertheless, noted the relative scarcity of studies conducted on adolescent samples, thereby limiting the generalizability of findings to this age group. More recently, a meta-analysis has suggested that breakfast skipping is associated with elevated depressive and anxiety symptoms in adolescents, with no associations with anxiety symptoms observed in other age groups. These studies generally suggested that breakfast consumption plays a role in cognitive functions and mental health symptoms, although no study has yet simultaneously investigated the effects of breakfast skipping on both cognitive functions and mental health outcomes in young people, as well as their possible interrelationships.

Notably, an earlier national Japanese survey of high school students reported that those who skipped breakfast showed significantly higher levels of impulsivity. It is possible that breakfast skipping could be linked to deficits in inhibitory control processes [which are closely related to glucose imbalances and, in turn, affect mental well-being. Indeed, problems in the ability to focus attention and control impulses have long been linked to a vast range of mental health problems, particularly in young people. Whether reduced impulse control may serve as a mechanism that links breakfast skipping to mental health symptoms, even when adjusting for factors that might confound breakfast consumption patterns and their associations with mental health outcomes (e.g., pre-existing mental health problem, symptoms of eating restraints, and later rise time), warrants further investigation.

Extending observations in previous work, we conducted this study with three major aims: to determine the patterns of breakfast consumption in a population-representative household-based youth sample in Hong Kong; to investigate the associations between breakfast skipping, impulsivity, as well as depressive and anxiety symptoms and functioning outcomes; and to explore whether specific domains of impulsivity would mediate the effects of breakfast skipping on poorer mental health outcomes. We hypothesized that young people who more frequently skip breakfast would show poorer outcomes and that impulsivity, particularly in the cognitive and attentional domains, would mediate the effects of breakfast skipping on both depressive and anxiety symptoms.

Reference:

Wong, S. M. Y., Choi, O., Suen, Y. N., Hui, C. L. M., Lee, E. H. M., Chan, S. K. W., & Chen, E. Y. H. (2025). Breakfast skipping and depressive symptoms in an epidemiological youth sample in Hong Kong: The mediating role of reduced attentional control. *Frontiers in Psychiatry*, 16. <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsy.2025.1574119>

CLO 3: Apply coherence, logical reasoning, and supporting evidence in writing ideas.

Question 2: Imagine the role of a deserving student who has been selected for a scholarship program.

Write an application to Dr. Asad Khan, the head of the scholarship committee at FAST, expressing your interest in the program and highlighting your academic achievements. /15

Rubric:

Designation & address	Subject	Purpose	Reasons	Details dates & Suggested Action	Closing	Mechanics Grammar, punctuation Tone, Vocab & Cohesion	Total
/2	/1	/2	/3	/2	/3	/2	/15

CLO 3: Apply coherence, logical reasoning, and supporting evidence in writing ideas.

Question 3: Critically analyze the given excerpts and write a critical analysis of it in 280-300 words. /20

Note: Write three paragraphs stating *Introduction, Analysis and Conclusion (without headings)*.

Your critical analysis should include:

Introduction:

- Title
- Author's name
- Date of publication
- Main idea of the article

Analysis:

- Tone -> *Serious concerned*
- Style -> *Formal*
- Pattern -> *Cause and effect*
- Purpose -> *To persuade*
- Justification of all of them

Conclusion:

- Summary of analysis
- Your opinion

Highlight tone, style, pattern and purpose with marker.

The Silent Water Crisis—Pakistan's Most Overlooked Emergency

By Dr. Samina Qureshi

(Published in *South Asian Policy Review*, March 12, 2023)

Pakistan's water crisis has steadily transformed from an environmental concern into a national emergency. Although the country has experienced recurring water shortages for decades, recent climate shifts, rapid population growth, and poor management have accelerated the decline of its water resources. What was once considered a distant threat has now become a daily reality for millions? The primary cause of Pakistan's water scarcity is the mismanagement of existing resources. Despite being a river-dependent nation, the country lacks adequate storage facilities to capture seasonal flows. Each year, millions of cubic meters of freshwater simply drain into the Arabian Sea because the infrastructure needed to store it remains outdated, damaged, or insufficient. This loss directly affects agricultural production, undermining food security and rural livelihoods.

Climate change further intensifies the crisis. Rising temperatures have reduced glacial mass in the northern regions, disturbing the natural flow of water into the Indus Basin. Unpredictable rainfall patterns have created long periods of drought followed by sudden floods, overwhelming both urban drainage systems and rural irrigation networks. The imbalance between water supply and demand results in reduced hydropower generation, increased electricity shortages, and heightened social tensions in water-stressed areas. Population growth and urban expansion have created additional pressure on limited water sources. Cities like Karachi, Lahore, and Quetta now rely heavily on over-extraction of groundwater, which has led to alarming drops in water tables. As a consequence, millions of residents face daily struggles to access drinking water, while industries continue to exploit underground reserves with minimal regulation.

The effects of the water crisis extend beyond environmental degradation. Economic losses continue to rise as agriculture suffers from inadequate irrigation and industries face operational disruptions. Health issues have also surged, particularly waterborne diseases, as people are forced to consume contaminated water due to the limited availability of safe alternatives. Experts warn that if Pakistan fails to reform its water governance system, the country could reach absolute water scarcity within the next decade. To prevent this, Pakistan must prioritize long-term planning, invest in modern infrastructure, ensure transparent distribution mechanisms, and promote public awareness campaigns encouraging responsible water usage. Without such measures, the crisis will continue to deepen, increasing instability and reducing the country's resilience against future challenges. These issues should be addressed urgently, as Pakistan's water crisis remains one of the most pressing and overlooked emergencies of our time—a crisis that demands immediate attention and informed policy action.

Citation:

Qureshi, Samina. "The Silent Water Crisis—Pakistan's Most Overlooked Emergency." *South Asian Policy Review*, 12 March 2023.

Rubric:

Introduction	Analysis	Conclusion	Total
4	12	4	20

CLO 3: Apply coherence, logical reasoning, and supporting evidence in writing ideas.

✓ **Question 4:** Paraphrase the given passage and provide the in-text citation.

/10

Despite new curriculum reforms and updated competency standards, the debate over which language should be used for teaching remains unresolved. Historically, the multilingual education system has tried to address the needs of diverse ethnic groups, but it has neither aligned the existing standards with global benchmarks. As a result, the issue persists. Countries like Finland have demonstrated strong academic outcomes while still promoting multilingualism. In the Pakistani context, students study for local and international exams in English, use technology in English, live in a society where English is the primary legal language, and enter careers that require English for professional communication. To prepare them for the future, language immersion is essential.

Published by Neda Mulji on June 11, 2025.

CLO1: Identify the author's main ideas, supporting details, and implied meanings from selected texts.

✓ **Question 5:** Read the given passage and answer the following questions.

/5

A pretty interesting trend popping up this year is the rise of "pay-by-weight" restaurants, and honestly, it's kind of genius. Instead of paying for a full meal or combo, you basically load your plate with whatever you want, then pay based on how much it weighs. It's becoming popular in a lot of cities because people are tired of wasting food and money on huge portions they don't even finish. Plus, it feels a bit fun—like you're building your own perfect meal. Some places are even mixing it with healthier options, so you can try tiny amounts of new dishes without committing to a whole serving. Of course, there are people joking about how they avoid anything saucy because it "adds weight," but the whole idea still feels fresh and different.

1. Write the implied main idea of the excerpt.

/2

2. Identify the style of the passage and justify your answer by providing textual evidence in your own words.

/3

CLO 2: Identify and differentiate logical relationships in terms of author's purpose and organizational patterns in a text.

✓ **Question 6:** Read the given passage and answer the following questions.

/5

In today's digital world, millions of people rely on emails, social media, and online banking to manage their daily activities. However, this convenience has also opened the door to one of the most widespread cybercrimes: phishing. Phishing occurs when attackers disguise themselves as trustworthy organizations to trick individuals into sharing sensitive information such as passwords, credit card numbers, or bank details. These messages often appear legitimate, using familiar logos, urgent language, and convincing layouts to create a false sense of security. For instance, a typical phishing attempt begins with an email or message claiming that a user's account has been locked or that unusual activity has been detected. The message then urges the user to click a link, which leads to a fake website designed to capture their personal data. Many victims do not realize they have been deceived until unauthorized transactions or login attempts appear. The rise of smartphones has made the problem worse, as people quickly check messages without carefully examining their sources. Beyond personal financial loss, phishing also threatens companies and institutions. A single employee clicking a malicious link can expose entire networks to malware, data theft, or system shutdowns. As a result, organizations now train staff regularly to recognize suspicious emails and verify information before responding. Cyber security experts emphasize that prevention depends not only on technology but also on user awareness. Although phishing continues to evolve, understanding how these attacks work is the first step toward protecting one's digital identity.

1. Identify the dominant pattern of the passage and justify your answer by providing textual evidence in your own words.

/3

2. Identify the purpose of the passage and justify your answer by providing textual evidence in your own words.

/2